Harris Mukaram Ismael

Hadji Harris Mukaram Ismael is a Bangsamoro public servant, peace advocate, and communications leader whose work is anchored in one core conviction: that governance must be moral before it can be effective.

He serves as President of the **Bangsamoro League of Information Officers (BLIO)**, Founder of **Anak BangsaMORO**, and Chairman and Managing Director of **The Moro Peace Project (TMPP), Inc.**

Within the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM), he leads the **Project TABANG Information and Communications (PTIC)** unit, a component of Project TABANG, the humanitarian flagship program of the Office of the Chief Minister (OCM), where he champions transparency, accountability, and compassionate public service.

Carrying on a family legacy of commitment to the Bangsamoro cause, Ismael has spent nearly two decades in regional governance across a range of institutions, from tourism and agrarian reform to port management and economic zones. He's also earned recognition on both the national and international stage for his work in youth leadership, peace advocacy, and technology innovation.

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Background

Hadji Harris Mukaram Ismael comes from a family shaped by service and sacrifice.

His mother, Mrs. Nursia Babul Mukaram-Ismael, is a retired Chief Nurse. His late father, Nadzmi "Abdulgani" Abdurahman Ismael, was a Top-300 Foreign Trained Moro Front Commander, a man who devoted his life to the Bangsamoro struggle for self-determination.

Growing up in that kind of household, it's not hard to see where Ismael's drive comes from. He's described his work as a continuation of his father's legacy, except that instead of taking up arms, he's taken up the work of building institutions, fostering dialogue, and making sure the next generation of Bangsamoro leaders has something solid to stand on.

His advocacy is rooted in what he calls **Moral Governance**: the idea that public service is not merely a function of authority or policy, but a living, daily practice of sincerity, accountability, and putting others first.

Career and Public Service

Ismael's government career spans nearly two decades across the former Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (ARMM) and its successor, the BARMM.

He has served in a range of regional institutions, including the **Regional Ports Management Authority (RPMA-BARMM)**, the **Department of Tourism (DOT-ARMM)**, the **Regional Economic Zone Authority (REZA-ARMM)**, and the **Department of Agrarian Reform (DAR-ARMM)**.

Taken together, this range of postings reflects a career built not around a single sector, but around a genuine commitment to regional development in all its dimensions, economic, cultural, infrastructural, and social.

His current work through the Project TABANG Information and Communications (PTIC) unit places him at the intersection of humanitarian action and public communication. The unit operates under Project TABANG, the OCM's flagship humanitarian program, and Ismael's role there is to ensure that the region's people are kept informed, that government actions are transparent, and that accountability isn't just a talking point.

Leadership and Peace Advocacy

Beyond his government posts, Ismael has built a substantial track record as a youth and peace leader.

He served as **Former Chairperson of the Peace and Security Committee** of the Bangsamoro Youth Parliament (Batch 2021), under the **Bangsamoro Youth Commission (BYC)**, bringing a security and peacebuilding lens to the region's youth governance structures.

On the international front, he has served as:

- **Country Ambassador**, Michael Madsuhudan Debate Federation (Bangladesh)
- **Global Peace Ambassador**, Global Peace Chain
- **Deputy Lead Ambassador for BARMM**, Global Institute for Youth Development, Inc.
- **Executive Consultant**, Southeast Asia Young Peacebuilders Organization (SEAYPO)

These roles place Ismael in a network of regional and global peacebuilders, and reflect how the Bangsamoro peace process is increasingly being understood not just as a local political matter, but as part of a wider conversation about youth, conflict resolution, and sustainable governance across Southeast Asia and beyond.

Hadji Harris Mukaram Ismael



Known For	Peace advocacy, moral governance, information leadership
Current Roles	President, Bangsamoro League of Information Officers (BLIO); Founder, Anak BangsaMORO; Chairman and Managing Director, The Moro Peace Project (TMPP), Inc.
Region	Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM)
Affiliation	Bangsamoro, Moro
Parents	Mrs. Nursia Babul Mukaram-Ismael (mother); Nadzmi "Abdulgani" Abdurahman Ismael (father, deceased)
Awards	Outstanding Leader of 2022, International Leaders Achievers Awards; Outstanding Leader of 2022, International Icon Awards; Top 10 Nominee, Bangsamoro Peace Champion Award (2023)

Through **Anak BangsaMORO**, the organization he founded, he's taken this commitment inward, building platforms and pathways for young Bangsamoro men and women to engage meaningfully in civic and political life.

Technology and Innovation

In 2018, Ismael stepped into a different arena and showed he could compete there, too.

He participated in the **Hack4PH Challenge**, a national hackathon organized by the **Department of Information and Communications Technology (DICT)**, and emerged as champion in the **Hack2Play Category** under the theme "Enriching Travel Experience."

His team developed an application designed to assist tourists and travelers in exploring destinations across the Philippines, an inventive, practical solution that the organizers recognized as genuinely out-of-the-box. The win is a signal that Ismael's vision for the Bangsamoro isn't limited to traditional governance frameworks. He sees technology as a tool for empowerment and inclusion, and he's willing to prove it.

International Engagement

Ismael has represented Filipino and Bangsamoro perspectives on global stages at multiple points in his career.

In **2020**, he represented the Philippines at the **Global Youth Model United Nations**, engaging with youth delegates from across the world on issues of peace, security, and development.

From **2019 to 2022**, he contributed as a **Researcher** for the **Global Opinion Leader Research Panel**, a multi-year engagement that placed him among international voices shaping policy-relevant discourse.

Recognition

Ismael's work has earned him formal recognition both locally and internationally.

In **2022**, he was named **Outstanding Leader** by both the **International Leaders Achievers Awards** and the **International Icon Awards**, two separate recognitions in the same year that speak to the breadth of his reputation across different audiences.

In **2023**, he was named among the **Top 10 Nominees for the Bangsamoro Peace Champion Award**, under the Ministry of Peace and Order (MPOS) of the BARMM. The nomination placed him among the region's most recognized contributors to the ongoing work of building peace in Muslim Mindanao.

Legacy

Hadji Harris Mukaram Ismael's career is, at its heart, a sustained argument that governance can be something other than transactional.

His concept of Moral Governance, leadership rooted in faith, compassion, and accountability, runs through everything he's done: the years of public service across multiple agencies, the youth organizations he's built and supported, the international platforms he's shown up on, the hackathon he won.

He's not building a legacy through a single dramatic act. He's building it through consistent, unglamorous, deeply committed work across decades and institutions, exactly the kind of work the Bangsamoro region needs more of.

His life also carries a quiet message for young Bangsamoro people: that the struggle their parents and grandparents waged doesn't end with the peace agreement. It continues, through governance, through communication, through technology, and through the stubborn, daily insistence on doing things with integrity.

See Also

- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM)
- Bangsamoro Youth Commission (BYC)
- The Moro Peace Project (TMPP)
- Project TABANG
- Bangsamoro League of Information Officers (BLIO)
- Profile provided by Harris Mukaram Ismael (https://www.facebook.com/harris.ismael)

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